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Project Management 6.5

Project Needs Analysis

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - Use Planning Tools
  - State why needs analysis is required
  - Assess project needs
  - Give relevant examples

How do we assess project needs?

- This is a different activity than assessing the needs for the project outcomes
- This process assures that there are adequate project resources available to the project team
  - This includes many key project elements
    - Human Resources
    - Finance
    - Time
    - Physical resources
    - Information needs

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All about getting the benefit

- In order to get benefits, we have to assess the needs for the outcome as well
- **These areas are integrally connected, not separate from each other**
- This means that all resources have to be identified, and a reasonable tolerance built in to the project resources to account for the unexpected.

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In the beginning

- The first step in carrying out needs assessment
  - There is a need to gather information about what is needed
  - Consult with employees whose expertise will be critical to the project
  - What technology, tools or other resources will be needed to carry out the tasks required
  - Important to seek the opinions of end users.

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Next important steps

- The second step is to identify the problem
- Prioritise the key activities
  - Risk management
- Identifying potential risks and issues.

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And then…

- Establish solutions
- Assess different solutions
  - More than one option?
  - Project or organisational constraints.

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Finally…

- Gaining consensus
- Agreeing on the final solution
  - They will need to be informed of what is needed and they must agree to the allocation of finances and resources outlined in the needs assessment.
  - They need to agree to this within reasonable tolerances – clarity is **critical.**

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To recap

- Gathering information
- Identifying issues, risks and response
- Informing stakeholders of what is required
- Making sure that key decision makers sign off on the commitment of resources.

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Look Forward

- L7.1 Build and Test